

Sunday, 26 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Heavy drizzle

25° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

20° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

19° 15°

GLASGOW

Light rain

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 British holidaymakers are describing their frantic escape from raging wildfires across the south of France.

Families have told how their summer breaks quickly turned into evacuation missions as fires spread rapidly. Thousands of residents and tourists have been forced to flee their homes and campsites.

WEATHER · UK

2 Twenty firefighters have been taken to hospital after a huge explosion at an industrial site in Essex.

The blaze, which started at a farm, spread to a fertiliser store, causing the blast. Essex's chief fire officer has praised the incredible courage of the crews involved.

INCIDENT · UK

3 Police have declared a 'major incident' in the Cairngorms after a wildfire threatened homes in Nethy Bridge.

Some residents in the village have been asked to leave their properties as a precaution. Firefighters are battling to contain the blaze and prevent it from spreading further.

WEATHER · UK

4 We're getting an exclusive behind-the-scenes look at Andy Burnham's first week as Prime Minister.

Journalist Laura Kuenssberg has been given unique access to the new PM's early days in charge. It promises to offer a fascinating insight into the corridors of power.

POLITICS · UK

5 A murder investigation is underway in Luton after a 17-year-old boy died from stab wounds.

Police say the teenager was taken to hospital with multiple injuries but sadly passed away shortly after. Officers are appealing for any witnesses or information.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The King and Queen made a spectacular entrance to open the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, emerging from a Tardis!**

The royal couple drew gasps and cheers from the audience at the Hydro as they appeared on stage. It was a memorable start to the sporting spectacular.

ON AIR – What a way to kick off the Games! What was your favourite moment from the opening ceremony?

EVENT · NOW
- 2 Charli XCX has just dropped her new album, and it's getting a lot of attention for its raw honesty.**

Called 'Music, Fashion, Film', the star's latest work reportedly strips away the usual artifice to examine her life. It comes after the phenomenal success of her previous album, 'Brat'.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Charli XCX? What do you think of artists getting really personal in their music?

MUSIC · NEW
- 3 The popular football game EA FC has received a new age rating due to changes in rules around loot boxes.**

The game's hugely popular 'Ultimate Team' mode has earned it a 16+ rating from the age ratings board PEGI. This reflects growing concerns about in-game purchases.

ON AIR – Do you think age ratings for video games are important? Should loot boxes be more regulated?

GAMING · NEW
- 4 An 'enormously important' painting, valued at over £100,000, has been uncovered on a TV show.**

The artwork, by 18th Century Scottish artist Katherine Read, was discovered during an episode of 'Fake or Fortune'. It's a significant find for the art world.

ON AIR – Imagine finding a masterpiece hidden away! What's the most valuable thing you've ever stumbled upon?

ART · NEW
- 5 A pop band who once played for rescue dogs are now selling out arenas across the country!**

The group has been discussing their journey from disastrous early gigs to huge success. They also talk about putting political action into their music and the meaning of 'queer pop'.

ON AIR – What a story! What's the most unusual place you've ever seen a band perform?

MUSIC · NEW

On the schedule

1 **An England gymnast suffered a horror fall at the Commonwealth Games, overshadowing his team's silver medal.**

Gabriel Langton's dramatic fall happened during the men's team event on the opening night of action in Glasgow. It was a difficult moment for the team, despite their medal success.

ON AIR – That must have been a tough moment for Gabriel. Do you think the pressure on gymnasts is immense?
GYMNASTICS · UK

2 **Sean McCann, the younger brother of Madeleine McCann, has reached the 400m freestyle final at the Commonwealth Games.**

It's a fantastic achievement for Sean, competing on a major international stage. All eyes will be on him in the final.

ON AIR – What a brilliant personal achievement for Sean! Are you following any particular athletes at the Commonwealth Games?
SWIMMING · UK

3 **Tyson Fury has won a low-key warm-up fight in Thailand, keeping his potential blockbuster with Anthony Joshua on track.**

The British heavyweight stopped Mariusz Wach in the bout. Boxing fans will be hoping this means the highly anticipated Joshua fight is now closer to becoming a reality.

ON AIR – Are you excited for a potential Fury vs Joshua fight? Who do you think would win?
BOXING · UK

4 **Tadej Pogacar is on the verge of a record-equalling fifth Tour de France title after a stunning Alpe d'Huez victory.**

The defending champion took a storming victory on stage 19 of the iconic race. He looks set to cement his place in cycling history.

ON AIR – Five Tour de France titles would be incredible! Is Pogacar one of the greatest cyclists of all time?
CYCLING · GLOBAL

5 **Birmingham Phoenix beat Trent Rockets in a record-breaking thriller in The Hundred, setting a massive new score.**

The Phoenix posted a whopping 214 runs, the highest score ever seen at Edgbaston in The Hundred. Despite a valiant chase from the Rockets, the target was just too much.

ON AIR – What a high-scoring game! Do you enjoy the fast-paced action of The Hundred cricket?
CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are finding that even a short walk in a local park can significantly boost creativity.**
New research suggests that just twenty minutes surrounded by nature helps to clear the mind and encourage fresh ideas, making those lunchtime strolls more powerful than you might think.
- 2 The joy of 'upcycling old furniture' is experiencing a big revival across the UK.**
Many are rediscovering the satisfaction of transforming pre-loved pieces into stylish new additions for their homes, saving money and adding a unique touch.
- 3 There's a growing trend for 'community seed-swaps' in local areas.**
Gardeners are gathering to exchange seeds, share growing tips, and foster a real sense of local connection, helping each other's gardens flourish.
- 4 Researchers have discovered that listening to the 'sound of gentle rain' can improve focus.**
The consistent, non-intrusive sound acts as a natural white noise, helping many to concentrate better on tasks or simply unwind.
- 5 The simple pleasure of 'baking bread from scratch' is becoming a popular weekend pastime.**
The scent of freshly baked loaf and the satisfaction of creating something delicious by hand is bringing a comforting ritual into many kitchens.
- 6 Vintage board games are making a comeback, with many families opting for a screen-free evening.**
Classic games like 'Monopoly' and 'Cluedo' are proving to be popular again, bringing generations together for some good old-fashioned fun.
- 7 The charming hobby of 'collecting quirky teacups' is gaining popularity among enthusiasts.**
People are enjoying hunting for unique designs at antique shops and markets, creating a delightful and personal collection for their afternoon brew.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to be a good day?

ANSWER: ...CHECKING THE TEA LEAF PATTERNS IN OUR MUG.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, hot cup of cocoa. What is it?

ANSWER: ...MAKING SURE THE MARSHMALLOW COUNT IS PERFECTLY EVEN.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those little 'secret shortcuts' you've discovered in your local area?**
Perhaps it's a hidden path through a park or a back street that saves you time. What's your best-kept local shortcut?
- **Think about those 'everyday objects' that you have a surprisingly strong sentimental attachment to.**
Maybe it's an old mug, a worn-out jumper, or a particular pen. What is it, and what makes it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the sound of rustling leaves can be louder than a human whisper?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's a fact that flamingos turn pink because of a special pigment they absorb from eating only pink grapefruit.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the only living structure visible from space.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand.
- It takes approximately 10 minutes for a spacecraft to reach space.
- The deepest part of the ocean, the Mariana Trench, is deeper than Mount Everest is tall.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur to help absorb sunlight and keep warm.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.

On this day

Day 207 of the year, 158 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew of Phú Yên; Christian feast day: Anne and Joachim (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Bartolomea Capitanio; Christian feast day: Blessed Camilla Gentili. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Peter Hyams, American director, screenwriter, and cinematographer
- 1950 — Susan George, English actress and producer
- 1957 — Nana Visitor, American actress
- 1945 — Helen Mirren, English actress
- 1956 — Tim Tremlett, English cricketer and coach
- 1944 — Betty Davis, American singer-songwriter (died 2022)
- 1978 — Eve Myles, Welsh actress
- 1974 — Iron & Wine, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1953 — Cold War: Fidel Castro leads an unsuccessful attack on the Moncada Barracks, thus beginning the Cuban Revolution. The movement took the name of the date: 26th of July Movement
- 1968 — Vietnam War: South Vietnamese opposition leader Trương Đình Dzu is sentenced to five years hard labor for advocating the formation of a coalition government as a way to move toward an end to the war.
- 1963 — Syncom 2, the world's first geosynchronous satellite, is launched from Cape Canaveral on a Delta B booster.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1953 — Arizona Governor John Howard Pyle orders an anti-polygamy law enforcement crackdown on residents of Short Creek, Arizona, which becomes known as the Short Creek raid.
- 1958 — Explorer program: Explorer 4 is launched.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1953 — Soldiers from the 2nd Battalion, Royal Australian Regiment repel a number of Chinese assaults against a key position known as The Hook during the Battle of the Samichon River, just hours before the Armistice Agreement is signed, ending the Korean War.

- **1953 — Cold War: Fidel Castro leads an unsuccessful attack on the Moncada Barracks, thus beginning the Cuban Revolution. The movement took the name of the date: 26th of July Movement**
- **1974 — Greek Prime Minister Konstantinos Karamanlis forms the country's first civil government after seven years of military rule.**

A peek at tomorrow

Day 208 of the year, 157 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthusa of Mantinea; Christian feast day: Aurelius and Natalia and companions of the Martyrs of Córdoba.; Christian feast day: Blessed Maria Maddalena Martinengo; Christian feast day: Maurus, Pantalemon, and Sergius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Julian McMahon, Australian actor and producer (died 2025)
- 1967 — Neil Smith, English cricketer
- 1946 — Peter Reading, English poet and author (died 2011)
- 1947 — Betty Thomas, American actress, director, and producer
- 1972 — Maya Rudolph, American actress and comedian
- 1977 — Jonathan Rhys Meyers, Irish actor
- 1984 — Kenny Wormald, American actor, dancer, and choreographer
- 1967 — Juliana Hatfield, American singer-songwriter and musician

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1955 — The Austrian State Treaty restores Austrian sovereignty.
- 2015 — Seven people are killed and many injured after gunmen attack an Indian police station in Punjab.
- 1964 — Vietnam War: Five thousand more American military advisers are sent to South Vietnam bringing the total number of United States forces in Vietnam to 21,000.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1995 — The Korean War Veterans Memorial is dedicated in Washington, D.C.
- 1955 — El Al Flight 402 is shot down by two fighter jets after straying into Bulgarian air space. All 58 people on board are killed.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)